

TraceVault - Investigation Report

Incident Summary

Filename	test_phishing_sample.eml
Source	manual_upload
Status	analyzed
Uploaded At	2026-09-09 05:21:45.696384
Evidence ID	58d44111-9cf0-45f2-a40d-bebed19c2fcf

Evidence Integrity

Hash Algorithm	SHA-256
SHA-256 Hash	7a0927a82a9bcb67b9a1edc27e829c06d6e3b86365df663d8a20cf1997473209

AI Analysis Findings

Attack Type	Phishing
Severity	High
Confidence Score	1.00

Threat Summary: The email uses urgency and fear tactics to trick the recipient into clicking a malicious link mimicking PayPal. The domain 'paypa1-verify.com' is a typosquatting attempt designed to harvest user credentials.

Root Cause Analysis

Entry Point	Email delivery
Attack Vector	Email
MITRE Technique	T1566.002

Explanation: The attacker registered a look-alike domain to impersonate a legitimate service. The email failed all authentication checks (SPF, DKIM, DMARC), confirming the sender is unauthorized and malicious.

Header & Authentication Analysis

SPF	Fail
DKIM	Fail

DMARC	Fail
From Address	PayPal Security Team
Display Name	PayPal Security Team
Reply-To	support@totally-different-domain.net

GeoLocation & Relay Trace

IP	Location	ISP	Confidence
8.8.8.8	Ashburn, United States	Google LLC	Medium
1.1.1.1	South Brisbane, Australia	Cloudflare, Inc	Medium
202.12.27.33	Fujisawa, Japan	WIDE Project	Medium

URL Reputation (VirusTotal)

URL	Verdict	Malicious	Suspicious
http://paypa1-verify-secure.com/login	Clean	0	0

Compromised Assets

Type	Value	Severity
Email	security@paypa1-verify.com	High

Recommendations

Containment:

- Identify and purge all emails originating from the look-alike domain across the mail server
- Revoke active sessions for users who interacted with the malicious email links or attachments
- Block the look-alike domain at the organizational email gateway and web proxy

Recovery:

- Reset credentials for any users who provided information on the phishing site
- Perform a full forensic scan of affected endpoints to identify potential secondary payloads
- Verify integrity of user accounts for unauthorized mailbox rules or forwarding configurations

Future Prevention:

- Enable strict DMARC 'reject' policies to block unauthorized spoofed emails automatically
- Deploy automated URL sandboxing and link-rewriting security tools
- Implement domain monitoring services to proactively detect and take down look-alike registrations